FJ 10310/10

FROM WASHINGTON TO FOREIGN OFFICE — 52

Cypher/OTP

FOREIGN OFFICE AND
WHITEHALL DISTRIBUTION

Sir O. Franks
No. 186
16th Jamary, 1952.

D. 8.54 p.m. 16th January, 1952.
R. 7.41 a.m. 17th January, 1952.

CONFIDENTIAL

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 186 of 16th Jamary.
Repeated for information to Tokyo,
and Saving to Singapore.

FJ10310/4

Your telegram No. 313 - Sino-Japanese Relations.

I saw Acheson this evening and told him that you were distressed by the publication of Yoshida's letter at this time and in this manner. I pointed out that its terms bore out all that you had said to the Americans and would give the impression that Chiang is to be recognised as more than the occupier of Formosa. I said that if you had understood that a letter of this kind was to be published now, and in the way it had been, you would have wished to stress your views even more strongly at your meeting with Acheson. You were surprised to have had no advance notice from the Americans of the intention to publish.

2. Acheson asked me to convey to you at once his strong regret at what had occurred. He was very sorry that you had not received information about the intent to publish or about the manner of publication. He wished me to make it clear that this happening in relation to your discussion with him was unintentional He was very sorry that it had happened. The Americans ought to have gone into the whole question of Congressional time-tables with us, and they had not done so.

3. I then told Acheson of the line we were taking in the comment in London and at this Embassy and in Tokyo. Acheson appreciated our attitude and said the Americans would back it up by confining their replies to any questions they received about Yoshida's letter in its relation to British policy to a similar restatement of the general position you had taken.

/4. You asked

JAN 1952

Reference:
FO 371/99403
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION

Washington telegram No. 186 to Foreign Office

4. You asked me about the message Sir E. Dening was to deliver, quoted in paragraph 4 of your telegram No. 109 from Washington. My recollection is that this message was devised only because Acheson thought that Yoshida would ask Dening what our attitude was. I do not see the need for Dening to deliver it in the present circumstances. The line suggested by him in paragraph 3 of his telegram No. 72 seems to meet the position.

Foreign Office please pass Tokyo and Saving to Singapore as my telegrams Nos. 7 and 6 respectively.

[Repeated to Tokyo and Saving to Singapore].

Reference:
FO 371/99403
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION